PMO Portfolio Dashboard: One-Page Brief

By: Mahalakshmi S

The problem

A finance PMO that runs 15 internal projects cannot tell at a glance which ones are late, over budget or failing to deliver savings, and project managers can report a better status than their own numbers support. This dashboard answers four questions on one screen: is anything late or over budget, are people logging their time, are projects delivering savings, and can the reported status be trusted.

About the dataset

The data is simulated: a dummy portfolio of 15 finance projects, inspired by the kind of work a large express-logistics company such as **DHL Express** might run. It contains no real DHL data, and the yellow and red styling is DHL Express inspired. This is an independent portfolio project, not affiliated with or endorsed by DHL.

- **Scope:** 15 projects, 5 departments (Procure to Pay, Order to Cash, Billing, Financial Accounting, Reporting & Controlling), 5 regions and 3 project types (RPA Automation, Tool Rollout, Process Harmonization). Total budget EUR 3.725M, as of 30 Sep 2026.
- **Three tables:** Projects (15 rows: budget, dates, forecast cost, savings, reported colour), Monthly (180 rows: planned and actual spend, hours allocated and logged, Oct 2025 to Sep 2026) and DateTable (12 months).
- **Built with realistic problems:** statuses that do not match the numbers, stale updates, cost overruns and savings shortfalls.

Project_ID	Project_Name	Department	Project_Type	Region	Project_Manager	Sponsor	Strategic_Theme	Budget_EUR	Forecast_At_Completion_EUR	Baseline_Start	Baseline_End_F
P01	Invoice Matching Automation	Procure to Pay	RPA Automation	Europe	Lena Vogel	Henrik Dahl	Cost Reduction	180,000	176,400	05-May-2025	30-Nov-2026
P02	Billing Error Detection Bot	Billing	RPA Automation	AMER	Rahul Menon	Carla Mendes	Data Quality	220,000	226,600	16-Jun-2025	04-Dec-2026
P03	Customer Credit Note Automation	Order to Cash	RPA Automation	APAC	Wei Tan	Priya Iyer	Cost Reduction	150,000	163,500	07-Jul-2025	13-Nov-2026
P04	PPM Tool Rollout - Wave 1	Reporting & Controlling	Tool Rollout	Global	Sofia Almeida	Jonas Keller	Digitalization	520,000	540,800	07-Apr-2025	29-Jan-2027
P05	Time Registration Standardisation	Reporting & Controlling	Process Harmonization	Europe	Marcus Bell	Jonas Keller	Compliance	140,000	141,400	04-Aug-2025	18-Dec-2026
P06	Month-End Close Harmonisation	Financial Accounting	Process Harmonization	Global	Sofia Almeida	Elena Rossi	Compliance	260,000	278,200	19-May-2025	15-Jan-2027
P07	Cash Application Automation	Order to Cash	RPA Automation	MEA	Rahul Menon	Priya Iyer	Cost Reduction	190,000	224,200	23-Jun-2025	18-Sep-2026
P08	Vendor Master Data Cleanup	Procure to Pay	Process Harmonization	APAC	Wei Tan	Henrik Dahl	Data Quality	110,000	112,200	14-Jul-2025	11-Dec-2026
P09	Expense Reporting Tool Rollout	Financial Accounting	Tool Rollout	AMER	Lena Vogel	Elena Rossi	Digitalization	430,000	481,600	12-May-2025	26-Feb-2027
P10	Billing Dispute Workflow	Billing	Tool Rollout	Europe	Marcus Bell	Carla Mendes	Cost Reduction	340,000	414,800	28-Apr-2025	31-Aug-2026
P11	Intercompany Reconciliation Automation	Financial Accounting	RPA Automation	Europe	Sofia Almeida	Elena Rossi	Cost Reduction	275,000	275,000	09-Jun-2025	04-Dec-2026
P12	Global Reporting Dashboard Refresh	Reporting & Controlling	Tool Rollout	Global	Rahul Menon	Jonas Keller	Digitalization	200,000	212,000	21-Jul-2025	20-Nov-2026
P13	Tax Code Harmonisation	Billing	Process Harmonization	MEA	Wei Tan	Carla Mendes	Compliance	310,000	341,000	26-May-2025	15-Sep-2026
P14	Freight Invoice Audit Automation	Procure to Pay	RPA Automation	AMER	Marcus Bell	Henrik Dahl	Cost Reduction	240,000	232,800	30-Jun-2025	27-Nov-2026
P15	Accruals Forecasting Model	Reporting & Controlling	Tool Rollout	Europe	Lena Vogel	Elena Rossi	Data Quality	160,000	166,400	18-Aug-2025	10-Dec-2026

Figure 1. Projects table (dataset)

Month	Project_ID	Planned_Spend_EUR	Actual_Spend_EUR	Hours_Allocated	Hours_Logged
Oct-2025	P01	6,700	6,400	384	381
Nov-2025	P01	8,500	8,100	432	435
Dec-2025	P01	10,300	9,900	480	500
Jan-2026	P01	12,200	12,200	480	496
Feb-2026	P01	13,400	12,700	480	484
Mar-2026	P01	13,400	11,700	480	498
Apr-2026	P01	13,400	13,100	480	506
May-2026	P01	13,400	12,600	480	475
Jun-2026	P01	12,800	12,100	480	506
Jul-2026	P01	12,200	11,800	480	502
Aug-2026	P01	12,200	11,800	480	488
Sep-2026	P01	12,200	12,500	480	481
Oct-2025	P02	8,400	9,200	320	319
Nov-2025	P02	10,700	11,000	360	353
Dec-2025	P02	13,000	13,900	400	400
Jan-2026	P02	15,200	16,200	400	390
Feb-2026	P02	16,800	18,400	400	395
Mar-2026	P02	16,800	16,400	400	373
Apr-2026	P02	16,800	18,200	400	379
May-2026	P02	16,800	16,000	400	381

Figure 2. Monthly table (dataset)

Month_Start	Year	Quarter	Month_Label	Month_Sort	Is_Latest_Month
01-Oct-2025	2025	Q4 2025	Oct 2025	1	N
01-Nov-2025	2025	Q4 2025	Nov 2025	2	N
01-Dec-2025	2025	Q4 2025	Dec 2025	3	N
01-Jan-2026	2026	Q1 2026	Jan 2026	4	N
01-Feb-2026	2026	Q1 2026	Feb 2026	5	N
01-Mar-2026	2026	Q1 2026	Mar 2026	6	N
01-Apr-2026	2026	Q2 2026	Apr 2026	7	N
01-May-2026	2026	Q2 2026	May 2026	8	N
01-Jun-2026	2026	Q2 2026	Jun 2026	9	N
01-Jul-2026	2026	Q3 2026	Jul 2026	10	N
01-Aug-2026	2026	Q3 2026	Aug 2026	11	N
01-Sep-2026	2026	Q3 2026	Sep 2026	12	Y

Figure 3. Date table (dataset)

What I built

A two-page Power BI report with an Overview page and a Project Detail page. Both pages share the same four filters. Page 1 is Overview:

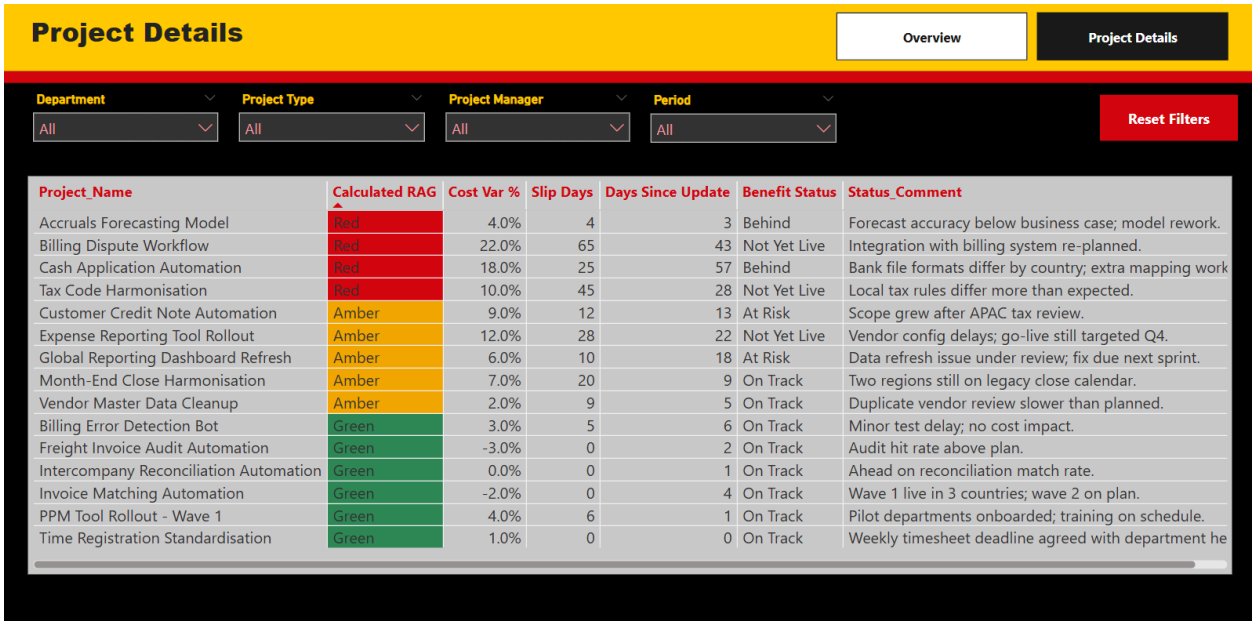


Figure 4. Overview (Dashboard)

- **Filters:** Department, Project type, Project manager and Month, plus a Reset filters button. The Month filter changes only hours and utilization, because budget and savings are not monthly.
- **Three headline sentences** that rewrite themselves when a filter changes: Red projects and status mismatches, hours logged and stale updates, cost and savings against plan.
- **Five KPI cards:** total budget, cost variance, % projects green, resource utilization, benefit realization.
- **Projects by calculated status:** Red, Amber and Green counts. Clicking a bar filters the whole page.
- **Reported status vs what the numbers say:** only projects whose reported colour is better than the calculated one, with cost variance and days since update.
- **Budget vs forecast vs spend to date:** switchable by project, department, region, project type or strategic theme.
- **Promised vs forecast annual savings:** one pair of bars per project.
- **Hours allocated vs hours logged by month:** columns, with a utilization line.

Page 2 is Project Detail:

- **Project health table:** every project in one table, Red first, with calculated status colour, cost variance, slip days, days since update, benefit status (on track, at risk, behind or not yet live) and the manager's status comment. It follows the same filters. Buttons switch between the two pages.



Project_Name	Calculated RAG	Cost Var %	Slip Days	Days Since Update	Benefit Status	Status_Comment
Accruals Forecasting Model	Red	4.0%	4	3	Behind	Forecast accuracy below business case; model rework.
Billing Dispute Workflow	Red	22.0%	65	43	Not Yet Live	Integration with billing system re-planned.
Cash Application Automation	Red	18.0%	25	57	Behind	Bank file formats differ by country; extra mapping work
Tax Code Harmonisation	Red	10.0%	45	28	Not Yet Live	Local tax rules differ more than expected.
Customer Credit Note Automation	Amber	9.0%	12	13	At Risk	Scope grew after APAC tax review.
Expense Reporting Tool Rollout	Amber	12.0%	28	22	Not Yet Live	Vendor config delays; go-live still targeted Q4.
Global Reporting Dashboard Refresh	Amber	6.0%	10	18	At Risk	Data refresh issue under review; fix due next sprint.
Month-End Close Harmonisation	Amber	7.0%	20	9	On Track	Two regions still on legacy close calendar.
Vendor Master Data Cleanup	Amber	2.0%	9	5	On Track	Duplicate vendor review slower than planned.
Billing Error Detection Bot	Green	3.0%	5	6	On Track	Minor test delay; no cost impact.
Freight Invoice Audit Automation	Green	-3.0%	0	2	On Track	Audit hit rate above plan.
Intercompany Reconciliation Automation	Green	0.0%	0	1	On Track	Ahead on reconciliation match rate.
Invoice Matching Automation	Green	-2.0%	0	4	On Track	Wave 1 live in 3 countries; wave 2 on plan.
PPM Tool Rollout - Wave 1	Green	4.0%	6	1	On Track	Pilot departments onboarded; training on schedule.
Time Registration Standardisation	Green	1.0%	0	0	On Track	Weekly timesheet deadline agreed with department he

Figure 5. Project Details (Dashboard)

Three findings

1. **5 of 15 projects report a better status than the numbers show.** Three report Green but calculate Amber, and two report Amber but calculate Red. Only 6 of 15 are truly Green (40%), while 4 are Red.
2. **The two worst-reported projects are also the stalest.** Cash Application Automation (18.0% over budget, 25 days late) has had no update for 57 days, and Billing Dispute Workflow (22.0% over, 65 days late) for 43 days. Both report Amber.
3. **The portfolio is heading 7.0% over budget and 9.1% short on savings.** Forecast cost is EUR 3.99M against a EUR 3.73M budget, and forecast savings are EUR 3.65M against EUR 4.02M promised. Savings realized so far are 93% of the pro-rated target, and hours logged are 91% of hours allocated.

Colour rule and assumptions

The calculated colour comes from three numbers per project. The thresholds are my assumption, based on common PMO practice, not an official rule.

Colour	Forecast cost over budget	End date slip	Forecast savings below plan
Red	more than 15%	more than 30 days	more than 25%
Amber	5% or more	8 days or more	10% or more
Green	below all Amber limits		

A project takes the worst colour that any one test gives.

- Data is synthetic, in EUR, as of 30 Sep 2026.
- Cost variance is forecast at completion vs budget. Savings are tracked for 12 months after go-live against a pro-rated target.
- Utilization is hours logged divided by hours allocated. A project is stale after 30 days without an update.

What I would do next

- Replace the synthetic data with a live export from the PPM tool and schedule a refresh.
- Agree the colour thresholds and KPI targets with the PMO lead and finance (see the governance rulebook).
- Add change-versus-last-month arrows to the KPI cards.
- Pilot the dashboard with two departments and collect their feedback before a wider rollout.